

# Yixi Chen

PhD Candidate in Management, Columbia Business School  
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## EDUCATION

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| <b>Columbia Business School</b><br><i>PhD in Management (Organizational Theory)</i><br>Dissertation: “Stigma Disclosure, Narrative Framing, and Entrepreneurial Evaluation”<br>Committee: Paul Ingram (Chair), Adina Sterling, Dan Wang, Sandra Matz, Kylie Hwang <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>Finalist</b>, INFORMS/Organization Science Best Dissertation Proposal Competition (2026)</li></ul> | <b>New York, NY</b><br>2027 (expected) |
| <b>The University of Chicago</b><br><i>M.A. in Social Sciences (Concentration: Sociology)</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Winner of the Johnson Thesis Prize for best thesis in social sciences (2020)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Chicago, IL</b><br>2020             |
| <b>Mount Holyoke College</b><br><i>B.A. in History &amp; Economics Double Major (Magna Cum Laude)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>South Hadley, MA</b><br>2016        |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Identity; Social Evaluation; Social Networks; Entrepreneurship; Computational Social Sciences

My dissertation examines a central puzzle in identity and social evaluation: when can a founder's stigmatized identity become an unexpected source of advantage rather than remaining a liability? Across studies of entrepreneurs with neurodivergent conditions and entrepreneurs with incarceration records, I develop and test the concept of *stigma as distinction*, showing how stigmatized identities can become signals of distinctiveness in contexts that reward differentiation. Using a combination of video and written-vignette experiments, surveys, and interviews, I examine how stigma disclosure shapes investor evaluations and resource acquisition.

## MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Chatman, J., **Chen, Y.**, Choi V., & Gelfand M. Organizational Culture and Firm Performance under Volatility: Evidence from Glassdoor. (Forthcoming at *Academy of Management Discoveries*)

Ingram, P., and **Chen, Y.** Paradox of Concealment: Incidence and Consequences of Concealing Lower-Class Identities. (2<sup>nd</sup> round R&R at *American Journal of Sociology*)

**Chen, Y.**, Hwang K, Ponce de Leon, R. Entrepreneurial Storytelling and Audience Evaluation among Formerly Incarcerated Entrepreneurs. (Under Review at *Strategic Management Journal*)

- INSEAD Doriot Entrepreneurship Conference (Abu Dhabi, 2025)
- Equitable Opportunity Conference (MIT, 2025)

Doering, L., Sterling A., and **Chen, Y.**, Gender, Feedback, and Persistence: Evidence from Academic Research Grants (Under Review at *American Sociological Review*)

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**Chen, Y.** “Maverick or Misfit? Stigma Disclosure and the Evaluation of Neurodivergent Entrepreneurs”

- INFORMS/Organization Science Best Dissertation Proposal Competition (2026)
- Wharton People & Org Conference (scheduled, 2026)

## WORKING PAPERS

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**Chen, Y.**, and Ingram, P. Gender and Network Tie Decay (preparing for submission to *Academy of Management Journal*)

**Chen, Y.\***, Cho, S.\*, Yue, L., and Minefee I., “Historical Legacies and Corporate Sociopolitical Activism: The Case of Firms’ Responses to the Black Lives Matter Movement in 2020” (preparing for submission to *Strategic Management Journal*)

**Chen, Y.** & Wang, S. “How Personal Narratives Reshape Racial Discrimination: Evidence from Airbnb” (second round data analysis)

## OTHER PUBLICATION

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Brown, Derek., **Yixi Chen**, Jenny Chatman, Sameer Srivastava, Amir Goldberg, Paul Vicinanza. “How Have Organizational Cultures Shifted During the COVID-19 Pandemic”, *California Management Review*, Vol 63, Issue 4 <https://cmr.berkeley.edu/2021/07/how-have-organizational-cultures-shifted/>

## ORGANIZED SYMPOSIA

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**Yixi Chen** & Kylie Hwang, “Marginalized Identities in Organizational Evaluation, Creative Production, and Careers”, 2026 AOM, *Showcase Symposium*

**Yixi Chen** & Kylie Hwang, “Navigating Inequality in Entrepreneurship: Strategies and Evaluations of Marginalized Entrepreneurs”, 2024 AOM

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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\* Denotates scheduled presentation

(2026) Wharton People & Organizations Conference\*, Equitable Opportunity Conference, East Coast Doctoral Conference, Academy of Management

(2025) INSEAD Doriot Entrepreneurship Conference, Equitable Opportunity Conference

(2024) Oxford Reputation Conference, Academy of Management, East Coast Doctoral Conference

## AWARDS & GRANTS

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Grant, Columbia Business School (\$5000)      | 2025          |
| Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Grant, Columbia University (\$1000) | 2025          |
| Lang Center Entrepreneurship Research Grant, Columbia Business School (\$5000)           | 2024          |
| Columbia University Doctoral Fellowship, Columbia Business School                        | 2021- present |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Mastercard International (New York &amp; Shanghai)</b> | July 2016 - August 2019 |
| <i>Senior Analyst, International Market</i>               |                         |

## TEACHING

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Leadership and Organizational Change (TA for Prof. Paul Ingram) | 2021-2025 |
| Organizational Change (TA for Prof. Adina Sterling)             | 2025      |
| Equity by Design (TA for Prof. Adina Sterling)                  | 2024      |
| Strategy Formulation (TA for Prof. Vanessa Burbano)             | 2024      |
| Entrepreneurial Strategy (TA for Prof. Michael Mauskopf)        | 2023      |

## SERVICE

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PhD Mentor for Columbia Undergraduate Business Scholars Program (2022 – 2026)

Co-organizer for 2024 East Coast Doctoral Conference (2024)

Organizer for weekly Macro PhD Students brownbag seminar (2023-2024)